

What's Next in India for **SUSE**, the 'Open, Open Source Company'?

With the Indian government and many top industry players adopting open source, it is no longer a buzz word. But what does its future look like? How is open source going to grow in India, and what role does SUSE plan to play in that? To understand this, **Ankita K.S.** from the **EFY Group** spoke to **Ronald de Jong** – *president of sales, SUSE*; **Phillip Cockrell**, *VP, WW Alliance sales, SUSE*; and **Rajarshi Bhattacharyya**, *country manager, SUSE India*.

Q Why do you call SUSE 'an open, open source company'?

De Jong: Let me first give you an overview of what we do. We build software for software-defined infrastructure and application delivery. Today, we have operating systems like SUSE Linux Enterprise Server, around which you have all kinds of products like SUSE Linux Enterprise High Availability Extension, SUSE Linux Enterprise Live Patching, SUSE Manager to manage your environment and update your systems, and many more. We also have specific operating systems for points of sale. Moreover, we have products like Private Cloud that is based on OpenStack, Cloud Application Platform that is a PaaS solution based on Cloud Foundry, as well as SUSE Enterprise Storage which is based on the Ceph open source project. So, if you view them all from a software-defined infrastructure perspective, you will see that we have all those elements that you need to have for a complete open source stack. But we are not like other companies that ask you to buy their whole stack. That's why we call ourselves an open, open source company.



Ronald de Jong – president of sales, SUSE

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In the past we were doing more hand-to-hand training, like close combat, but now we take a large strategic view to create more skills.
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companies. We also welcome other hardware vendors to work with us, because we are not competing with other open source companies that work on middleware and databases. It gets tricky to work together with a company if you are a competitor — that doesn't happen in our case.

Q How different is India in terms of adopting open source software? Is the scenario changing?

Bhattacharyya: I think that India was a little behind in adopting open source in comparison with other countries, but with government initiatives like Digital India, we are establishing the pillars of infrastructure completely around open source. Right from the software for smart cities to that for access control systems, everything is being developed on open source. Since the past seven years, all the projects developed for service delivery, too, are built on open source. So, prioritising open source is high on the government's agenda today. Decision makers in the government are also aware enough to understand that they require enterprise-grade open source

in order to maintain stability, sustainability and security. So, open source is enabling us to grow very fast.

Q What is your strategy when it comes to working with other open source companies?

De Jong: Our strategy is to give specific parts of the stack to other companies to use. This is because a lot of companies already have some of the parts, and we don't want to make them throw their investments away. We are happy if they want to use our complete stack, but we try to make sure there are no losses. We are working very well with other open source

Q So is India on SUSE's radar too?

De Jong: Yes, definitely! This is the second time in the past three months that I am visiting India. Since I am responsible for the global operations, I need to prioritise my visits and India tops the list. During my visits, I meet all the systems integrators (SIs), and have discussions with them to understand what they